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Feb. 26, 1944
England

Dearest Martha,

I got some
tired off from the English-
girls so I thought I
would write you.

I want to ask you
just one question.

Do you like to work
& sew clothing? Please
answer that question.

I was reading
the "Stars & Stripes" that
is the paper put out by
the Army over here.

They have an article about
Army Nurses I will cut
it out and send it to
you. I hope you like

it.

Say did you see the
Picture "The Girl he
left behind.."? Well,
if you did not you
better see it. But
if you did, ^{would} you please
send me the words
to the song "No Rose;
no Nothing till my Baby
~~Love~~ Comes Home."
I know that's the
first line but not
the title. That is if
you know the word
to it.

I do not have any
of your letters to answer
for a change. That is
because they are sleeping

our mail for a couple of days. But when I get it there better be a letter in it or I will find out why you are going out with all the soldiers. Like you did to me on English women.

Well I am at the end of my rope.

I guess I better close... I got a letter for one of my boy friends in the Navy. And he had a bad me ~~he~~ of a time trying to get a date with a nurse. And when the night came for the date. The girl's mother called him

up and told him that he
 was change to night
 duty. That made me
 laugh. I remember the
 time you had night duty.
 and we could not go any
 place. Oh! Well you can
 not have night duty
 all your life. How about
 that.

I think of you a lot in
 fact I had a good dream
 about you last night.

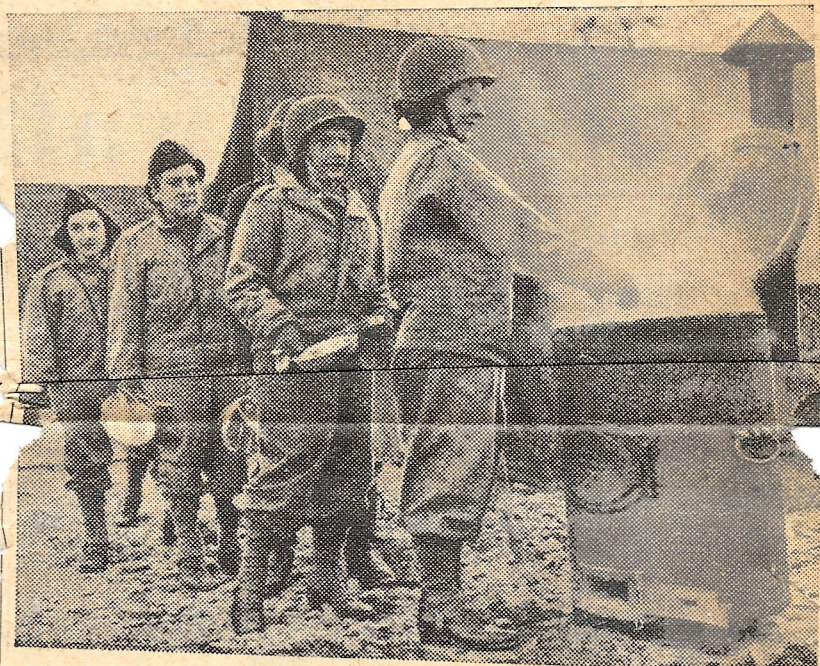
With Love

Misses.

Topi

P.S. I have not been to
 town in about 3 weeks.
 so the girls are doing very
 well I hope.

•Front Line' Tent Hospital Already Operating in ETO



Associated Press Photo
Toughening up for the second front, U.S. nurses somewhere in Wales line up to sterilize their mess kits before chow in a field kitchen.

A U.S. EVACUATION HOSPITAL, Britain, Feb. 25—Come mud or mire, American Army nurses are ready to slog it out on even terms with men no matter how rough the going when the Western Front opens.

More than 50 of them have been taking care of sick and wounded in a tent hospital here for four months under front line conditions—just to see if they can take it.

The answer is—they can!

They've been wet and they've been muddy and they've had to forget the gleaming, antiseptic smelling operating rooms and wards they knew in big hospitals back home. But they're sending their patients back to duty—which is the real test.

They started with just a muddy field. Ambulances slithered up in a downpour, the girls tumbled out and there was their hospital. It looked little more than a bog that first day last October, but before long damp and muscle-weary enlisted men had tugged soggy tents into position and the hospital was a going concern.

The nurses' only possessions were the clothes they were wearing, their suitcases and their bedrolls. The Army provided cots and tent stoves to drive out the autumn chill. But the girls had to rig their own clothes stands or foot lockers out of ration crates or packing cases.

They washed out of helmets and ate out of mess kits and took temperatures wearing khaki dungarees and boots. They weren't very glamorous, but they found out they could take good care of their patients even in wards floored with bare earth and walled and roofed with canvas.

The hospital, designed to handle 750

patients, is commanded by Lt. Col. Marshall S. Brown, of Lenox Hill Hospital, New York. 1/Lt. Lillian F. Carter, of New York, is chief nurse. In four months the doctors have treated everything from bullet wounds received in combat training to pneumonia.

"We plan to keep patients not more than 48 hours," Lt. Col. Brown explains. "In that time we get them classified and taken pretty good care of. Shock cases are treated, X-rays taken and operations done. We aim to have the resources of a fully equipped base hospital right in the front line."

The surgery is a 50-foot tent lighted by mobile generators; the operating table a litter supported at either end. The nurses wear scarves over their hair and masks over nose and mouth.

For the girls the most distasteful thing about their camp is not the mud nor the damp 6.30 AM chow line; the chilling run to get a cup of water out of a Gister bag late at night nor the washing in a helmet—but the rats.

Lt. Carter spoke for all her girls when she said:

"We hate rats, but they are something you must be ready to get used to on a battlefield."